

Stakeholder Analysis & Commitment Scale

Order Processing Efficiency Improvement Project

1. Stakeholder Identification & Analysis

Stakeholder Group	Key Members	Role / Interest	Impact on Project	Influence Level
Executive Sponsor (Operations)	VP Operations	Project authorization, strategic alignment, resource allocation	Critical - Can approve/block project	Very High
Finance Department	Finance Director, Budget Manager	Budget approval, ROI monitoring, financial benefits realization	High - Controls funding (\$75K)	High
IT Department	IT Manager, System Administrator, Database Specialist	System configuration, data extraction, technical enablement	Critical - System access & changes needed	Very High
Warehouse Management	Warehouse Manager, Shift Supervisors (3)	Daily operations, process execution, staff management	Critical - Direct process owners	High
Customer Service Team	CS Manager, 2 Senior Analysts	Customer feedback, issue escalation, performance monitoring	Medium - Handles customer impacts	Medium
Warehouse Staff (Hourly)	20 pickers, 10 packers, 5 quality checkers	Process execution, daily work changes, frontline feedback	High - Must execute new process	Medium
HR / Training	HR Manager, Training Coordinator	Staff training, change management, performance management	Medium - Enables staff adoption	Medium
Shipping / Carriers	Shipping Coordinator, Carrier Representatives	Coordination, pickup timing, handoff optimization	Medium - External touchpoint	Low-Medium

2. Stakeholder Commitment Scale Framework

Commitment Levels (8-point scale):

8 Enthusiastic Support	7 Active Support	6 Willing Support	5 Compliant	4 Skeptical	3 Reluctant	2 Hostile	1 Blocking
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3. Current vs. Desired Commitment Assessment

Stakeholder Group	Current Commitment	Desired Commitment	Gap	Engagement Strategy
Executive Sponsor	8 - Enthusiastic Support	8 - Enthusiastic Support	✓ None	Maintain monthly sponsor reviews, highlight progress
Finance Director	4 - Skeptical	7 - Active Support	+3 (Priority)	Monthly financial reports, ROI tracking, early wins communication

IT Department	5 - Compliant	7 - Active Support	+2 (High)	Allocate dedicated resource, recognize IT contribution, provide autonomy
Warehouse Manager	7 - Active Support	8 - Enthusiastic Support	+1 (Medium)	Involve in solution design, recognize staff improvements
Customer Service	7 - Active Support	7 - Active Support	✓ None	Regular communication on project progress affecting customer impact
Warehouse Staff	5 - Compliant	6 - Willing Support	+1 (Medium)	Transparent communication, address concerns, involve in pilots
HR / Training	6 - Willing Support	7 - Active Support	+1 (Medium)	Early training plan development, resource allocation
Shipping/Carriers	5 - Compliant	6 - Willing Support	+1 (Low)	Quarterly coordination meetings, shared benefit communication

4. STAKEHOLDER INFLUENCE / INTEREST MATRIX

This matrix positions stakeholders by their ability to influence the project outcome and their level of interest in project success.

**HIGH INFLUENCE
LOW INTEREST**

Strategy: SATISFY

Keep satisfied with minimal engagement

Shipping/Carriers (low)

**HIGH INFLUENCE
HIGH INTEREST**

Strategy: MANAGE CLOSELY

Highest priority engagement

Executive Sponsor, IT, Finance,
Warehouse Manager

**LOW INFLUENCE
LOW INTEREST**

Strategy: MONITOR

Regular updates only

Warehouse Staff (indirect interest)

5. ENGAGEMENT PLAN BY STAKEHOLDER

Executive Sponsor (VP Operations)

- **Current Status:** Enthusiastic Support (8)
- **Engagement Method:** Monthly executive steering committee meetings
- **Communication Frequency:** Monthly (1 hour meetings)
- **Key Messages:** Business ROI, timeline adherence, milestone achievements
- **Issues/Escalations:** Budget overruns, timeline delays, scope changes

Finance Director (Priority - CONVERT from Skeptical to Supporter)

- **Current Status:** Skeptical (4) → Target: Active Support (7)
- **Concern:** ROI unproven, "another Six Sigma project"
- **Engagement Method:** Bi-weekly financial tracking reports, early wins celebration
- **Communication Frequency:** Bi-weekly (15-min touchpoints + monthly detailed review)
- **Key Messages:** \$1.2M annual benefit, 16:1 ROI, monthly cost tracking, risk mitigation

**LOW INFLUENCE
HIGH INTEREST**

Strategy: INFORM

Keep engaged and informed

Customer Service,
HR/Training

- **Tactics:**
 - Share case studies of similar successful projects
 - Provide detailed financial model with sensitivity analysis
 - Report early wins (even small ones: \$5K monthly cost reduction in Measure phase)
 - Involve in monthly steering committee for visibility
- **Success Indicator:** Supports project recommendation, allocates additional resources if needed

IT Department (Priority - Increase from Compliant to Active Support)

- **Current Status:** Compliant (5) → Target: Active Support (7)
- **Concern:** Competing priorities, resource constraints, "not their project"
- **Engagement Method:** Dedicated IT project resource with clear role, weekly tech meetings
- **Communication Frequency:** Weekly (30-min technical sync)
- **Key Messages:** IT autonomy on solutions, IT will be recognized for success, minimal system disruption
- **Tactics:**
 - Assign one senior IT person as full project team member
 - Provide IT recognition in project communications
 - Allow IT to propose technical solutions (not dictated)
 - Include IT in improvement benefits (system performance improvement)
- **Success Indicator:** Proactively identifies technical opportunities, advocates for project in IT meetings

Warehouse Manager & Staff

- **Current Status:** Active to Compliant (5-7) → Maintain/Increase to Willing-Active (6-7)
- **Concern:** Fear of change, potential job security concerns, additional work during implementation
- **Engagement Method:** Bi-weekly operations meetings, pilot testing, training involvement
- **Communication Frequency:** Bi-weekly team meetings + daily shift briefings during implementation
- **Key Messages:** Process improvements will make job easier, no job elimination, staff input valued
- **Tactics:**
 - Involve in problem identification and solution design
 - Run pilot with volunteer group before full rollout
 - Provide clear training schedule well in advance
 - Address concerns about workload changes honestly
 - Recognize and celebrate improvements publicly
- **Success Indicator:** Staff voluntarily participate in pilots, provide constructive feedback, implement changes smoothly

Customer Service & Finance Support

- **Current Status:** Active Support (7)
- **Engagement Method:** Monthly updates, involvement in benefits measurement
- **Communication Frequency:** Monthly meetings
- **Key Messages:** Customer satisfaction improvement, complaint reduction, operational efficiency
- **Tactics:** Monthly metrics dashboard showing customer impact improvements

6. RISK MITIGATION: STAKEHOLDER-SPECIFIC RISKS & MITIGATION

Stakeholder / Risk	Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Finance Director Withdrawal	Finance loses interest if early results are not visible	Medium	High - Budget could be cut	Establish monthly metrics dashboard; identify quick wins in Measure phase (\$50K cost savings demonstration)

IT Resource Conflict	IT diverts resources to emergency issues	Medium	High - Project delay	Secure written IT commitment; identify backup IT person; escalate conflicts to CIO immediately
Warehouse Staff Resistance	Staff resists changes, implementation slowdown	Medium	High - Benefits not realized	Transparent communication, pilot testing, training, recognition; listen to concerns
Sponsor Attention Loss	Sponsor loses focus due to other business priorities	Low	Medium - De-prioritization	Monthly steering meetings with clear agenda; escalation procedure for decision delays

7. STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION MATRIX

Stakeholder	Communication Method	Frequency	Primary Messenger	Topics / Content
Executive Sponsor	In-person steering meetings	Monthly	Black Belt Project Manager	Progress, milestones, budget, risks, decisions needed
Finance Director	Detailed financial reports + meeting	Bi-weekly	Green Belt + Finance member	Cost tracking, ROI progress, benefits realization, variances
IT Department	Technical sync meetings	Weekly	IT Project Member	Technical issues, data requirements, system configs, blockers
Warehouse Manager	Operations meetings	Bi-weekly	Black Belt / Warehouse Manager	Process changes, schedule, staffing, pilot results
Warehouse Staff	Shift briefings + team meetings	Daily (during implementation) / Weekly (other)	Warehouse Supervisor	Schedule changes, training, process updates, recognition
Customer Service	Monthly metrics review	Monthly	Black Belt	Customer impact, complaint trends, satisfaction metrics
HR / Training	Planning meetings	Bi-weekly	Black Belt / Green Belt	Training needs, schedule, materials, staff communication
All Project Team	Weekly project team meeting	Weekly	Black Belt Project Manager	Status, issues, progress toward milestones, next steps

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Next Review: After first engagement activities (Week 2) to assess commitment level changes